

ORDER AS A UNIVERSAL PRINCIPLE

Greetings, divine blessings for all of you, my dearest friends. The topic of tonight's lecture is entirely new. It is something I have never discussed before.

The universe is inconceivably orderly and organized. Every particle falls into its proper place. Infinitesimal little cogs and wheels mesh, interact, complement one another, and create an immense machinery that the human mind can never even remotely conceive. The harmony and creative grandeur of creation could never exist if the underlying principle was not order. This exactitude and mathematical orderliness must escape the human vision. Only your vaguest sensing can, at times, make you aware of a greater order. For in the fragmented vision at your disposal, where you see everything out of context, you may indeed see chaos and disorder.

Chaos and disorder in human life are of course reality -- being a consequence of distortion. But I am now talking about universal processes such as nature. You may perceive chaos in nature -- or what appears as such. Some natural phenomena are apparently destructive. Yet, in that very occurrence lies the larger order.

Orderliness is a by-product of divine harmony. In this lecture I would like to discuss what constitutes inner order or disorder as well as outer order or disorder; their meaning and their connection and relationship with one another.

Inner order exists when human beings are totally conscious, when there is no longer any unconscious material. Since there is no human being of whom this could be said, order exists only to relative degrees in human life just as every other divine manifestation can exist only to relative degrees. Man can experience love, truth, wisdom, peace, bliss, reality only relatively and to varied degrees. So it is with order. An entity that is totally conscious of himself and the universe is no longer born into human substance and material manifestation. His life and his whole being are in total order with no loose ends.

Conversely, wherever there is lack of awareness, to that degree there must be disorder. If you are not aware, you cannot be in truth, in comprehension, and then things slip away from you. You become confused. Confusion and disorder are mutually interactive. You grope in the dark, as it were, making the half-truths at your disposal into a patchwork with which you attempt to fill the holes and gaps of your chaos.

Most people can recognize this state in themselves if they focus their attention in this direction. The disorderliness of the mind becomes frantic and attempts to create a false order which only heightens the discomfort and the disorderliness. It is as though you shoved all the dirt under your furniture where it cannot be seen. But the atmosphere reeks of the hidden waste material.

False opinions, obsolete behavior patterns are literally waste material that ought to be shed. If they stay in the psyche, all your opinions, perceptions, all your actions and decisions are based on half-truths or on complete distortions and error. The result must be chaotic and disappointing. Unless a person is willing to make order in all this accumulated confusion and psychic waste material by examining carefully every single attitude, belief, reaction, and feeling in him, he will continue his patchwork until the whole false structure collapses. Collapse, as you know, exists in many different forms. The most radical is physical death. This always affords the possibility to start with a clean slate.

On the outer plane the same process exists. It is not only symbolical of the inner life, it is an expression of it. If a person accumulates old obsolete material in his closets and drawers; if he never cleans out; if he just tries to establish a superficial order in his outer affairs, he lives in the illusion of his false order at great expense. We shall later go into this in more detail.

So you must realize that there is a direct connection between harmony and order on the one hand and awareness on the other. When there is disorder in the life of a person, he always evades, escapes from something. He pursues a policy of avoidance. Thus he creates the darkness of disorderliness. You can now perhaps see another connection: avoidance and lack of awareness are obviously intimately connected. Avoidance fails to establish order -- on whatever level. On the inner level this happens by not dealing with all the accumulated material of the mind and emotions such as discarding old material, fitting valid mind and feeling stuff into the appropriate channels; thus being aware of self and instituting a harmoniously fluid operation within the psychic system.

On the material level, this would manifest by going through the trouble and effort of the same procedure as far as one's outer surroundings are concerned. This may apply to one's belongings, one's things. It may apply to one's monetary affairs. Or it may apply to one's use of time. It may mean to overcome old habits of procrastinating, of postponing things to be done rather than dealing with them as they come up so as to free one's life from the clutter of accumulation.

The principle is the same whether it is the inner or the outer life. In both instances, it is necessary to make a decision to devote time, effort, and care to the running of one's life and a reorganization that affords one the possibility to have a smoother running operation. The more there is accumulated because of previous avoidance, the more effort will have to be expended to establish an orderly running of your affairs. But when this has been done and, in the process, new habit patterns formed in which avoidance gives way to instant dealing with, focusing on, and giving attention to whatever it may be, then an entirely new inner peace is automatically being established. No matter how much you meditate and pray, how much you devote your energies to great spiritual or artistic issues, this peace must be lacking if inner and outer disorder clutter up your life.

Avoidance, escaping from what is, automatically means that you do not know what is going on -- inside or outside of you. You become confused and disorganized no matter how much you try to hide this fact from your consciousness. You know very well that the path must always bring you to what you want to escape from. In your pathwork, as far as your inner life is concerned, as you face what you have evaded, you create more order, more light. You literally feel in you a sense of inner cleanliness and order you had lacked before. When you do not know what it is all about, when you avoid the point or the many points in question, you dwell in a dark mire that feels very uncomfortable.

A third aspect of order is reality. When you are in disorder, you live in illusion. You are in the illusion that the evasion, the lack of awareness, the not dealing with what must be dealt with if you are to live in peace and comfort will not have any impact on your life. You delude yourself that avoiding does not matter, that you will not be affected by it, that it has no creative impact on your life substance. This is indeed a great illusion. For nothing that you do or not do, commit or omit, can be effectless. It creates conditions. Your not doing something creates conditions and psychic substance just as much as your doing something. This applies every bit as much to a person's outer habits and outer orderliness, or its absence, as it does to the inner life.

Lack of awareness, avoidance, and illusion create and are by-products of disorder. And disorder creates more lack of awareness, avoidance, and illusion unless the mind and the will decide to tackle the issue profoundly once and for all, and then sustain the order.

Awareness -- dealing and focusing profoundly and completely on whatever the issue may be -- and reality -- facing the effects of one's manner of living -- create and are by-products of order and harmony. Order creates more awareness, more ability to focus and bring order as life unrolls, and thus more reality.

You breed disorder out of your illusion that it does not count or matter, that it "will go away by itself," and then you suffer from it. You may manage to escape from this particular suffering, due also to your disorder. Your avoidance may still be in progress. So you may manage not to be aware of your suffering. You may try to ascribe the tensions, anxieties, discomforts, pressures, bad conscience, nagging discontent to other matters. But the fact remains that it is your own self-created disorder that is responsible for so much of it.

It matters little whether the neglect to create order applies to "the big important issues" or the "unimportant" ones. The "smallest" neglect, thus disorder, festers and creates a lot of discomfort in the soul. This applies every bit as much to the person's outer habits and life as to the life of the soul.

The outer life is always related to the inner life in some way. It is very important for you, my friends, that you begin to pay attention to your outer life and habits from this point of view. So far we have dealt with this aspect only vaguely and not to its fullest scope. We have not yet dealt with it as a gauge of where the person inwardly stands. We have not paid attention to the fact that outer disorder diverts so much energy that the inner life must be shortchanged. You still fail to see that orderliness is a spiritual principle and its manifestation, or lack of it, reveals something about where the person inwardly stands. The truly spiritually unified person must therefore also be an orderly person in outer habits. He is not only clean about his person but equally clean about the handling of his daily life. He does not accumulate tasks by procrastination. He takes care of chores as they come up even if this means to undergo at the moment some effort instead of following the line of least resistance, and he values the peace that follows. Creating order always means an investment of effort. The spiritually mature person knows and accepts this. He does not live in the illusion that the same peace of mind and comfort can be attained without investing this effort. He realizes that what he gains outweighs what he invests. The spiritually mature person has order in all his inner and outer life in all matters. He relishes it and would not want it differently. But he pays the price for it. Thus he is in reality.

When man is disorderly in his outer life manifestations, in his personal affairs, about his person, about his surroundings or apartment or house, in his money matters, in the tasks he has to fulfill, a very insidious thing begins to happen. He is preoccupied with the disorder he creates. This is often an ongoing process. It never occurs to him that it could be different. Often he falls into a further illusion, namely, that creating order requires energy he does not have at his disposal. Nothing could be further from the truth. The ongoing disorder consumes energies, wastes them, dissipates them. Since order is a divine manifestation and therefore a natural one, the moment energy is summoned (perhaps at first with some effort and overcoming resistances), energy will be released. Much more energy becomes available, energy that was hitherto used to avoid reality and keep consciousness dim. When he is disorderly, man is constantly preoccupied whether he knows it or not.

It is therefore a tool of the unconscious negative intentionality to create inner and outer disorder. (With inner disorder, it is obvious. I no longer need to emphasize this for you. But it may be a new way for you to view outer disorder). In whatever aspect disorder exists, it fulfills the purpose of resistance to harmony, truth, health, and wholeness. Disorder creates tensions and preoccupations. It consumes valuable creative energy that could otherwise be used to find God within. I must repeat: man may not be conscious of the anxiety that his disorder on any level creates. But he must be anxious about it. It means that he leaves his own affairs unattended, that life is constantly slipping away from him, waiting to be lived and fulfilled in the morrow.

It is easy to see that if you accomplish your tasks on time, if you do not accumulate old waste, if you deal at once with the necessary issues, if you do not avoid, procrastinate, and delude yourself that it does not matter inwardly and outwardly, then you have control over your life. This is a healthy, necessary control. It is exactly the function of the ego to do so. Disharmony and distortion create imbalance so that a false lack of control exists where control should be. This always also creates the opposite, split off, distorted condition: false control compensates for the false lack of control, and vice versa. The overcontrol on the feeling level will be easier to relinquish when control is exerted where it is functional. To put it differently: if you hold yourself together in the right way and right place, it is easier to abandon yourself and relinquish control where that is right and to give in to feelings and involuntary processes. If a person has right ego control, he is much more capable of abandoning himself than when he lives in chaos and false abandon. The latter state makes it virtually impossible for him to let go of all his controls because, unless his ego has been strengthened through self-discipline, he would drown in his own chaos. So, you see, self-discipline is an unavoidable prerequisite for spiritual and worldly fulfillment. Only then can abandonment to the involuntary processes be safe. The self-disciplined person can give in to his spirituality, to his sexuality, to his deeper feelings and processes. He is safe. He stands on the firm ground of reality. He fulfills the functions of his ego rather than dispensing with it altogether, which is a false approach.

Order always means discipline. The immature person refuses discipline in any form because he associates it with parental authority against which he still wages his war. This, too, is among the obsolete waste material of soul stuff. The more you want parental authority to take care of your life for you, the more you rebel and the less do you adopt the attitudes that would make you capable of fulfilling your life with ease and peace. Thus you misinterpret self-discipline for deprivation. What an error! Actually, the more you refuse voluntary, self-chosen self-discipline, the more you unavoidably deprive yourself. You deprive yourself of the peace and comfort that are the products

of self-discipline and of the deep pleasure and bliss of the involuntary life stream that you can only allow to come through you when your ego stands on the firm ground you have built by self-discipline.

Create a new climate that facilitates your development, your growth, the solving of your painful problems, and the fulfillment of your real needs by learning self-discipline and thus establishing order in your life on all levels -- in the way you arrange your time, your money, your things, your surroundings, your personal appearance. Arrange your day in such a way that you, at least most of the time, take care of your tasks as they come. Organize the details in such a way that your day will run smoothly. Devote time and effort to create this order and to clean up old disorder. And then sustain it. Deliberately meditate for the energy, the consciousness, and guidance to follow through. If you experience a great deal of resistance to do so, let your helper help you to express the negative intentionality and deal with the meaning of it as you do in all other matters. Begin to view your outer life as a reflection of an inner attitude and intent.

However, if the resistance is not too great to execute this new mode of life, you will see what a difference it will make. You will recognize that burdens fall off your shoulders. You will relish the peace and comfort that will then give you all the more clarity and inner peace to solve your inner problems, to then give in to the deeper self. Because when you have the control where it is needed, you can relinquish control where it is not needed.

When there is outer disorder in a person's life, it always reflects the inner attitude, the inner sense of false abandonment, of wishful thinking, and of avoidance of something. It reflects your illusory state. However, if there is outer order in a person's life, this does not necessarily reflect that this is an expression of inner harmony and order reached. It may, and often is, an indication of the exact opposite. In that case, the outer orderliness is not an expression of inner orderliness but a compensation for, substitute of, and false attempt to resolve inner disorderliness. When orderliness becomes compulsive, when you are tense and obsessed with it, afraid and anxious when established routines cannot be met, that is a good gauge of the existence of inner disorderliness under the outer orderliness. If orderliness becomes a burden in a person's life, if orderliness exists at the expense of feelings, of expansion, of relaxation, of freedom, then that means that the innermost being is sending a message to the conscious self. The message says "Make order in you." But the message comes through garbled because the outer self is not sufficiently attuned to the inner self. The outer self is still too resistant to communicate with the inner self, to trust in its guidance and decipher its messages. Resistance to creating inner order is, as you all know, always strong. One person reflects this resistance in his outer life; the other type of personality misreads the message and only applies it to the outer plane. In such instances order always becomes compulsive and obsessive. The compulsive orderliness creates as much trouble and hardship in the person's inner life as his disorderliness does. The degree varies, of course. The strongest manifestations are wash compulsions and the like.

This is important to understand so that you do not fall into the error of blind, flat evaluation. You have to always look very carefully and sense the climate of the person's life. If the climate is relaxed and easy and the orderliness creates more ease in a person's life rather than more strain, then it is indeed an expression of the divine orderliness you find in the universe.

You have now another tool with which you can look at yourself in a yet newer light and gain new understanding. Those who are helpers can apply this tool both for themselves and those whom they help. Where you find disorder in your outer life in whatever areas it may manifest, begin to focus on your discomfort about it. Allow yourself to feel how much it disturbs and harasses you. You may be surprised to find out how many of your anxieties and tensions you had ascribed to insolubly deep conflicts will vanish as you discipline yourself. Of course, the resistance to self-discipline, the need to make disorder in your life is an expression of such deep problems. But it will help you greatly to tackle it also from the outside and actually rearrange your life in a new way. You may now be far enough to do so because you so choose with an inner understanding and not merely as an outer obedient act. The latter would not be very meaningful because you would resent it and do it in the expectation of pleasing the parental authority who is supposed to give you what you demand. If you would fail to "comply," you would feel falsely guilty and all this would rather hinder you. This is why I waited so long to discuss this topic.

Pay attention how disturbed you really are by your disorder. The resisting part in you knows that if you free yourself of the burden of disorder, your inner work will be so much easier. And the resisting part wants to avoid just that. The disorderly person is never able to concentrate. The same also applies of course to the compulsively orderly person who merely compensates for his inner disorder. Disorder makes concentration and focusing impossible. The mind must wander because it must be preoccupied with the things undone, with disorganized life and chaos. The mind may not wander in the direction of the disorder, in the direction of the immediate disturbance he has created by the disorderliness. It may wander to other topics. But if you really follow through the wandering thought and the content and climate behind it, you are bound to see how disturbed you are by the many little things in your life that you do not wish to tackle and set in order.

Often people negate this whole area as an important aspect of life. They may even feel it is pedantic to speak of order. It has nothing to do with the great, important questions of creativity, of spirituality, of life. But it is a fact that the great questions always rest on many "little" ones. The little attitudes fall into place as creation does in every tiniest detail; then your creative expression will be much less hampered, much more free. So, I ask you not to underestimate this topic.

You are now all profoundly enough involved with the deeper levels of your negation and destructive intent so that there is little danger for you to use outer orderliness as a false gauge and a false evaluation of your inner state. And those who newly joined the pathwork are enveloped by the rest of you who are sufficiently aware of yourselves to avoid the danger of glib judgment. This is also why I waited so long with giving this lecture.

I suggest as a task for all of you to look at your life from this point of view. In what way have you created an order that affords you ease and relaxation? In what way do you resist doing so? In what way do you suffer from your disorder? Are you aware of the fact that you do suffer from it? If you are not, search inside and see the indirect discomfort. Suddenly many little actions and reactions in your daily life will be recognized by you in a new light. You will become intensely aware of how much you do suffer from your disorder, how it was always so, how your disorder makes you lose yourself in the wrong way and thus prevents you from losing yourself in the right way.

In this connection I want to come back to one of the aspects I raised before, and that is avoidance. Avoidance exists all along the line, all across the board. You want to avoid seeing your

negativity, your destructiveness, your dishonesty, the little thoughts about how you wish to cheat even if you do not actually do it. This can be so easily overlooked and glossed over. Those invisible, secret thoughts and attitudes seem harmless to you, and you delude yourself that they have no impact on you. You want to avoid the feelings that are inconvenient. The price you pay for avoiding is literally insanity because if you go into what you avoid, there will suddenly appear the golden point in the middle, the wonderful point of truth and reality. Deep within the dreaded area, through the dreaded area, you find the golden point of light, of truth, of unification, of God.

Every area of avoidance bears within itself that golden point. Every dreaded point bears its golden center. Go toward it and all woe dissolves. Go away from it and you increase your suffering, your confusion, your darkness. You may think that there are areas that cannot be faced, that have no golden point at their ground: the areas of your terror or horror or your evil. This is not so. As long as you avoid; the terror, the horror and the evil live in you as phantoms. These phantoms create disaster and chaos. But turn around one hundred and eighty degrees, as it were, and instead of avoiding and going away from it, go into it no matter how bad it may feel at first. If you persevere and summon your courage and honesty and a minimum degree of faith, you will penetrate the darkness and will come to what I may designate as the "golden point" in the center of your being, in the center of the dreaded area.

Each dreaded area bears the seed of the golden point. There is no evil, no horror existing that does not bear the golden point within itself. There is no death that does not bear the golden point of life. There is no darkness that does not contain the golden point of brilliant light. There is no evil in you that does not bear the golden point of your goodness. If you can hold to this truth -- and it is truth indeed! -- it will become so much easier for you not to avoid, but to go through, to go through the tunnel of darkness into the golden area.

This is my message for you tonight. We shall terminate the lecture now and particular blessing is given for the meeting to follow. It is yet another step in creating the earthly place where such wonderful work, unfoldment, and love can exist. You have special blessings for this meeting and a great deal of guidance. I ask all of you that, immediately following this lecture now, as my instrument comes out of this state, as you are quiet and listen to the music, that you all meditate specifically for giving something of yourself to this venture -- your positive attitude, your positive intentionality, your good will, your good thoughts, your intention of giving your good feelings to it. If you do this, and the more you do this, the more wonderful the venture will grow. What will take place there increasingly will be something that cannot really take place in exactly that way when you are all in different places in the city where you cannot focus in the same way and be by yourselves in the same way. What will increasingly take place is, as I had announced, the transformation from negative to positive energy, from negative to positive consciousness. We have begun to do this to some extent. It is not coincidental that this new movement I had announced for this working year comes at the same time as your Center in the country is being established. There it will best take place. Your ability to make this transformation, to sustain and feel comfortable with positive feelings, energy, and consciousness will grow as result of having owned up and continuing to own up to the negative.

The work will go on constantly in these two ways, alternating between the exposure of the negativity and the transforming of the negative into the positive. You will learn more techniques and approaches as you will become ready for them in your progress. You will have the means, the

peace, the privacy, and the surroundings in which this will be possible to execute. The work will go on constantly in these two ways.

You have an indicative gauge. Where the positive is unbearable and cannot be sustained, it is an exact indication for you that, with all the recognitions you have made, you still have not quite accepted and exposed yourself and understood and faced negative attitudes in you. They may not even be different ones from those you already know in principle, but your knowledge is not sufficiently deep and wide. The acceptance is still absent. You are still submerged in it and half blind. You are not really cognizant of the way and the strength with which you perpetuate them. So your ability to bear good feelings, intimacy, love, and pleasure is an exact indication of that. The work in the Center will particularly help you for the transforming aspect of this twofold task. Everything that will come this year will go toward that direction. This is a wonderful thing to look forward to. Just think of the meaning of it. You will no longer need to take refuge in your negativity which appears to be more comfortable than love, closeness, and pleasure. Love, closeness, and pleasure will be the most comfortable and easy state to live in. This is the natural state and that is what you will attain.

Blessed be everyone of you, my dearest ones. Feel and accept the love that pours forth from the spiritual side. Be blessed, be in peace.

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